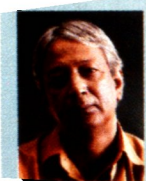


HORS D'OEUVRES **DILIP BOBB**

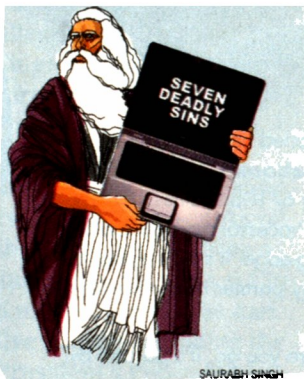
Good God!



In a country where reincarnation reigns in popular belief, here's some bad news. The number of sins that condemn us to eternal damnation and an afterlife of payback just got longer and include some that will be tough to resist, like littering, road rage or merely having an obscene amount of money. In fact, that should cover a large percentage of the population since even two of the above qualify for an afterlife sentence in hell. The new Seven Deadly Sins come as a result of serious deliberations in the Vatican where it was decided that the original sins fell far short of requirements in a modern world. Our sins, it seems, had multiplied with the passage of time and needed updating. Thus, the new sins target those who undermine society in far reaching ways, including by taking or dealing in drugs, polluting the environment and engaging in "manipulative" genetic science. Also new to the list are paedophilia, abortion and social injustices that cause poverty or "the excessive accumulation of wealth by a few".

For the last 1,500 years, the world of sin has been fairly simple. The original seven deadly sins, as conveyed in Dante's *Inferno* and by a 6th century Pope called Gregory were: Pride, Envy, Gluttony, Lust, Anger, Greed and Sloth. In a time of less stress and more equitable income, it was easy to stay ahead of the curve. They were pretty similar to the Ten Commandments. Lust is not much different to 'Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife' apart from specifics and the fact that in the 6th century, there were no cold showers. Or anger management techniques, since wrath now includes wife beating or road rage. New advances have brought new ways of sinning. The next time, loud cell phone conversations could make it to the list.

It's an interesting social development since the new sins are more tuned to modern temptations and violations. The reasoning behind adding to our list of things to avoid is hard to contest. The original seven deadly sins were largely individualistic but in the modern world, modern sins have a much bigger social impact. Topping the new Sin List is huge inequality of wealth with the poor getting poorer and the rich getting richer. Some of those Indians on the *Forbes* list better start brushing up on their Dante. Environmental irresponsibility is another, so dumping your garbage in the nearest river could condemn you to a life of eternal damnation. It's unclear which of the newer sins are mortal, but either way, it's a pretty big incentive to pick up your trash.



SAURABH SINGH



FAREWELL GAME: Kahn

The Last Kick of a Star

KOLKATA Football fanatics in the city may be looking forward to watching German goalkeeping legend Oliver Kahn play his farewell match in their very backyard when Bayern Munich take on Mohun Bagan at Salt Lake Stadium on May 27. But what could have been a football lovers' fantasy come alive is already mired in controversy.

The All India Football Federation (AIFF) is miffed because they came to know of the friendly match from the four-time European champion team's website. The Indian Football Association (IFA), which runs football in West Bengal, claims it had intimated the AIFF, which denies getting any such information.

Just when it seemed that the AIFF may not grant permission for the match, the federation's President and Information and Broadcasting Minister Priya Ranjan Dasmunshi said that given the stature of Bayern Munich, the AIFF would allow the match to take place, provided all

guidelines of FIFA, the sports international governing body, were followed. "The national association of the visiting side has to be intimated, all financial terms must be transparent, the nature of the match—whether for charity or an exhibition tie—has to be clear and the AIFF and the IFA (who will be organising the match) should have been informed well in advance," he said. Dasmunshi has a point, since it will be the AIFF who will be answerable to the world body.

While the match may finally kick off, it is unfortunate that such a high-profile team is being brought in to play against India's national team without following international guidelines. Will Kahn, arguably among the greatest to have ever tended goals, really want such a farewell?

Hopefully, all will be sorted out before the whistle and football lovers will be the winners in this ball game.

by Elora Sen